

# LI LU

*Last Updated: July 17, 2026*

## CONTACT INFORMATION

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Western University  
Ivey Business School  
1255 Western Rd.  
N6G 0N1

Phone: 647-390-8211  
Email: [alu.phd@ivey.ca](mailto:alu.phd@ivey.ca)  
LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/liklou/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/liklou/)

## EDUCATION

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| 2026—Now  | PhD, Business Economics and Public Policy, Ivey Business School |
| 2025—2026 | MA, Economics (Economics Research), University of Toronto       |
| 2023      | Summer Non-Degree Student, Università di Siena                  |
| 2021—2025 | BCOM, Finance & Economics, University of Toronto                |

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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### Works in Progress:

#### [Traffic Congestion and Local Government Fiscal Activities: Evidence from Urban China](#)

- Based on a panel of Chinese prefectures, this paper examines how traffic congestion shapes local governments' fiscal behavior. By employing dynamic System GMM estimators and documenting non-linear congestion effects as well as heterogeneity by initial debt burdens, I find that greater traffic congestion is associated with lower debt-to-revenue ratios, with the suppressing effect strongest under mild-to-moderate congestion and weakening at more severe levels.

#### [The Impact of Trade Tariffs on Corporate Greenwashing: A Strategic Perspective from China](#)

- This paper examines how tariff exposure shapes corporate greenwashing. I construct a text-based greenwashing measure from MD&A reports using a firm-level panel of Chinese A-share listed companies, and match it with environmental punishment data. I find that lower tariff pressure significantly increases symbolic environmental disclosure.

### Research Assistantships at University of Toronto:

- 2025–2026: Research Assistant on Transnational care in Chinese Transnational Families, for Professor [Weiguo Zhang](#), Department of Sociology
  - Managed the full survey lifecycle from design to implementation and feedback collection with Chinese elderly participants in Canadian local communities.
  - Conducted qualitative data analysis of Chinese-language interview transcripts using NVivo, including coding, theme identification, and clear documentation of the process.
- 2024–2025: Research Assistant on Anti-DEI Narrative at [Culture, Relationships, and Well-Being Lab](#), supervised by Professor [Soo Min Toh](#), Rotman School of Management
  - Conducted qualitative discourse analysis of U.S. university announcements using NVivo, including systematic coding and thematic analysis of Anti-DEI narratives.
  - Contributed to preliminary quantitative data processing and exploratory analysis in Python related to institutional discourse patterns.

### Research Assistantship at Cardiff University:

- 2025: Research Assistant on Tariff Exposure and Corporate Greenwashing in the Chinese Economy, for Dr [Zikang Liao](#), Cardiff Business School

- Conducted literature review and adapted established key variables, including HS-6-based tariff exposure measures and greenwashing indicators derived from annual reports.
- Collected firm-level panel data from Chinese listed company filings and trade statistics, and ran panel regressions in Stata to analyze the effects of tariffs on firms' disclosure behavior.

#### **Research Assistantship at Guangdong University of Finance and Economics:**

- 2024: Research Assistant on Tax Incentives and Corporate Greenwashing in the Chinese Economy, for Professor [Weibao Yao](#), School of Public Finance and Taxation
  - Assembled firm-level panel data from public disclosures and policy records, and estimated panel regressions in Stata to assess the impact of tax incentives on cooperate behavior.
  - Reviewed literature and constructed core variables, including tax-incentive exposure measures and other relevant indicators for robustness checks.

#### **INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE**

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| Summer 2024 | Summer Business Analyst, Capgemini Consulting, Guangzhou, China         |
| Summer 2023 | Summer Operations Analyst, Lucky Supply Inc., Mississauga, Canada       |
| Summer 2022 | Summer Operations Analyst, EF English First Co., Ltd., Guangzhou, China |

#### **TEACHING**

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##### **Sessional Instructional Assistant at University of Toronto (Summer 2026):**

- ECE472H1 - Engineering Economic Analysis & Entrepreneurship
- ECO370H5 - The Economics of Organizations
- MGE11H3 - Quantitative Methods in Economics I

##### **Teaching Assistant at University of Toronto (Winter 2024 - Winter 2026):**

- ECE472H1 - Engineering Economic Analysis & Entrepreneurship
- ECO370H5 - The Economics of Organizations
- ECO359H1 - Financial Economics II: Corporate Finance
- CCT325H5 - Media Economics II
- IMI301H5 - Essentials of Finance
- MGT301H5 - Coding and Data Mining for Business Analytics
- ECO204Y1 - Microeconomic Theory and Applications for Commerce (Head TA)
- MGT201H5 - Coding for Business

#### **HONOURS**

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| 2025-2026 | MA Representative at Graduate Economics Union, University of Toronto |
| 2025      | UofT Global Scholar, University of Toronto                           |
| 2021-2025 | Dean's List Scholar, University of Toronto                           |

#### **PROFICIENCIES AND OTHER INFORMATION**

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- Quantitative Analysis: STATA, Python, R, MATLAB, Jamovi
- Qualitative Analysis: NVivo
- Others: QGIS,  $\LaTeX$
- Language: Cantonese (Native), Mandarin Chinese (Bilingual), English (Professional)